How to run ExhaustShield in the organisation

Option A — Copilot Studio agent wrapping the ExhaustShield gate. Option B — one standalone dashboard every Entra user can open. Prices: Microsoft Copilot Studio Licensing Guide (Jun 2026), Learn billing rates, M365 Copilot $30/user/month, Groq gpt-oss-120b (Sep 2026).

BOARD RECOMMENDATION — Choose Option B

Standalone ExhaustShield dashboard for all 500 Entra users. Expected extra cost about **$120–$2,100 per year** versus Option A **$20,000–$23,000** (Studio credits) or about **$181,000/year** if you buy Copilot seats so Studio usage is zero-rated. Same gate. Broader coverage. Keep Microsoft Copilot for Office.

What we are deciding

ExhaustShield is a **prompt gate** (scan → Safe / Medium / High / Local), not a chatbot SKU. Microsoft 365 Copilot + Purview DLP is a **filter on Copilot**. Not everyone is E5 or Copilot-licensed. The question: where do **all 500 people** go for governed AI — and what does that cost **on top of** licences you already buy.

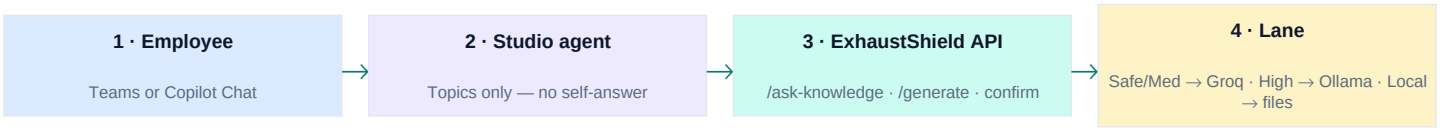
Item	Assumption used in the math
Population	500 people, mixed E3 / E5 — **not all Copilot-licensed**
Workdays	22 per month
Expected usage	**2 gated chats / user / day** = **22,000** conversations / month
Heavy usage	8 chats / user / day = 88,000 / month (sensitivity case)
Mix	~40% policy (Tab 2, no outside LLM) · ~60% generic chat (Tab 3)
Groq (outside brain)	$0.15 / 1M input · $0.60 / 1M output · about $0.0004–$0.0007 per short chat
Studio credits	PAYG **$0.01 / credit** · pack **$200 / 25,000 credits** (~$0.008). Unused packs **do not roll** to next month.
Agent action	**5 credits** per HTTP/tool call. M365 Copilot users: often **no charge** in Teams/Copilot. Everyone else **pays credits**.

Honest definition of Option A: Studio cannot be the classifier. “ExhaustShield in Studio” means a Studio **chat skin** that calls **your** gateway. You still host the Python gate (and Groq/Ollama). A Studio-only agent with Purview is **not** this pilot.

OPTION A — Copilot Studio agent + ExhaustShield API

Employees chat in Teams / Copilot · Studio must call our gate · High must never hit Microsoft's model

Architecture



You pay **Studio consumption** (for people without M365 Copilot) **plus** the same hosting + Groq as Option B. Overview / team insights stay on the dashboard unless rebuilt in Purview.

Credit math (people without M365 Copilot)

Policy turn ≈ 1 agent action (5 cr). Chat turn ≈ Check (5) + often Confirm (5) ≈ 10 cr. Blended ≈ **8 credits / conversation**.

Volume	Credits / month	PAYG $0.01	Packs $200
Expected 22,000 chats	176,000	**$1,760**	8 packs = **$1,600**
Heavy 88,000 chats	704,000	**$7,040**	29 packs = **$5,800**

Option A monthly cash — expected 22k chats (all 500 can use it)

Line	What it is	USD / month
Studio credits	If most of 500 do **not** have M365 Copilot ($30 USL)	$1,600 – $1,760
ExhaustShield host	Still required — VM / App Service + TLS	$90 – $150
Groq API	Safe / scrubbed Medium only	$10 – $25
Ollama High	Same VM — no licence	$0
Entra / Teams channel	Existing M365	$0
Build / connector	Custom connector + topics (internal weeks, not a SKU)	Labour
A1 TOTAL extra	**Studio skin + same brain as B**	**$1,700 – $1,940**

If the board "makes Studio cheap" by buying Copilot for all 500

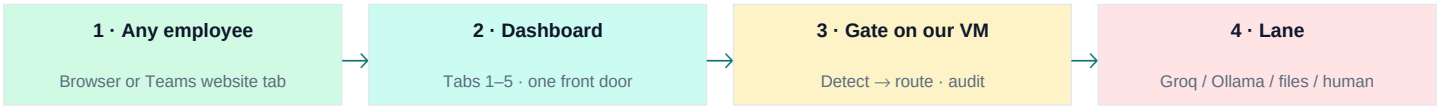
Line	Math	USD
M365 Copilot USL	500 × $30 / month (list, billed yearly)	$15,000 / mo · $180,000 / yr
Studio credits	Often $0 for those users in Teams/Copilot (fair use)	$0
Host + Groq	Still required for the real gate	~$100 – $175 / mo
A2 TOTAL extra	**Only if they do not already own 500 Copilot seats**	**~$181k / year**

A2 does **not** replace Option B's cost advantage: you still run ExhaustShield. You bought Copilot for Office plus zero-rated agent clicks.

OPTION B — Standalone ExhaustShield dashboard (recommended)

One URL / Teams website tab · Entra login · all 500 · code you already have

Architecture



Option B monthly cash — same 22k chats, all 500 can log in

Line	What it is	USD / month
Application	Existing FastAPI dashboard — no Microsoft agent SKU	$0
Host	Internal VM (often $0 extra) or Azure B-series	$0 – $150
Groq	~13k external chats × ~$0.0005 (policy stays local)	$10 – $25
Ollama	High lane on same box	$0
Identity	Entra SSO — existing tenant	$0
Distribution	Intranet link + Teams **website tab** (not Studio)	$0
Copilot seats	Unchanged — keep for Word / Excel / Teams	$0 extra
B TOTAL extra	**If you already have a server: Groq only**	**$10 – $175**

Year-1 extra cost (expected usage) — like-for-like

	A1 Studio credits	A2 + 500 Copilot	B dashboard
Monthly extra	$1,700 – $1,940	~$15,100 – $15,175	$10 – $175
Year extra	**$20k – $23k**	**~$181k**	**$120 – $2,100**
Covers non-Copilot staff	Yes, but they **generate the credit bill**	Yes, after $180k seats	**Yes — Entra only**
True Exhaust lanes	Yes, if API is wired correctly	Yes — same API	**Yes — native UI**
Management scoreboard	Split: Studio + our /api/stats	Same split	**Overview tab built-in**
Heavy 88k chats / mo	Studio ~$5.8k–$7k + host + Groq	Still ~$15k Copilot + Groq	Groq ~$40–$80 + host

Pilot-only (20 people, simulate or Groq free): Option B can be **$0**. Option A still needs Studio PAYG/packs as soon as non-Copilot users hit HTTP actions at scale.

THIS PILOT vs COPILOT + PURVIEW DLP

Purview is already useful — it is not ExhaustShield and it does not cover non-Copilot staff

Board question	Copilot + Purview DLP	ExhaustShield dashboard
What it is	Microsoft **filter on Copilot prompts** (SITs). Included with Copilot / Copilot Chat — configure, not a new Exhaust SKU.	Company **door**: scan then four lanes, confirm, scrub, private High, local no-LLM.
Who is in scope	People using **Copilot**. No Copilot / many E3 = **gap**. ChatGPT.com still invisible.	**Any of 500** with Entra + the URL.
Sensitive words	SITs you defined (SSN, PAN, custom). Default policy often starts in **simulation**.	Exact hide-spans used for mask/rewrite — demo scoreboard.
Which team used AI more	Copilot Dashboard / Viva: **adoption**, not lanes.	Lanes by team + sensitive-by-team on Overview.
Scrub then send	**No** — block processing or block web search.	**Yes — Medium**.
Private model / never leave	**No** — Copilot is Microsoft cloud.	**Yes — High** → **Ollama**.
Policy without an LLM	**No** — Graph + model.	**Yes — Tab 2**.
Cost to cover 500 this way	Buy Copilot for the rest: e.g. 300 × $30 = **$9,000/mo** — still not four lanes.	Option B extra **~$10–$175/mo**.

Purview limitations (say this once)

1. It does not sit in front of Groq / ChatGPT / Claude. 2. It does not implement Safe-confirm / Medium-scrub / High-Ollama / Local-files. 3. Insights are compliance (DLP hits) and Copilot usage — not “what would have left.” 4. Mixed E5 means mixed Purview depth. 5. Keep Purview **on** for Copilot users — complementary, not a substitute.

Why B outperforms A on benefits and cost

Benefit	Winner	Why
Cash at 500 mixed licences	B	~10–20× cheaper than A1 credits; ~80–100× cheaper than A2 Copilot seats
All 500 people	B	Entra + Teams tab. A bills or excludes non-Copilot users
Faithful Exhaust plan	B	Native UI for confirm / scrub / scoreboard. A is a thin chat wrapper + same API
Microsoft familiarity	A	Chat lives in Teams/Copilot — higher comfort, higher meter
Time to org pilot	B	Code exists. A needs connector, DLP allow-list, prompt-never-to-GPT tests

ASK OF THE BOARD

Approve Option B as the org pilot (Entra + Teams tab + Groq). Keep Copilot + Purview for licensed Copilot work. Revisit Azure OpenAI / Copilot Chat API later as a Groq swap — not a Studio rebuild.

Sources: Microsoft Copilot Studio Licensing Guide (16 Jun 2026); Learn “Billing rates and management” (classic 1 / generative 2 / agent action 5 credits; PAYG $0.01; pack $200 / 25k); M365 Copilot $30/user/month list; Groq gpt-oss-120b $0.15 / $0.60 per 1M tokens (Sep 2026). Your EA may discount Copilot. Credits unused in a pack month are lost. Azure VM quotes vary by region.